

SIGNATURE TALENT

Martha Kemp, Pillar of Main Street

EXECUTIVE



HIRE
◆ 5

SIGNATURE
Signature: one copy per deck.

Requires a Financials funding source.

Bank runs don't make you discard Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, or Evergreen Credit.

At the start of your turn, if you control an investment, gain 1 more Surplus.

Forty years at the same branch, where the only line out the door is for the holiday cookies.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 221 / 386

OFFICE LOCATION

New York

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN
◆ 4 branch only

Litigation

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

The first Investment you play on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

The deal closes before the lunch reservation does.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 358 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY
◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN
● 0 run start

STAPLE
▲ Rising Interest Rates

Staple: any number per deck.

A third of your Retail Deposits, rounded down, have no exposure.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Checking, savings, and a free toaster: the cheapest money in finance, until it all wants out at once.

ALPHA EX MACHINA NO. 034 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



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F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 386

Retail Deposits

FINANCIALS



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ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 034 / 386

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 386

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 386

Private Credit

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

CARRYING COST

● 1½ each turn

Carrying costs add up, then round down: one costs 1, two cost 3.

Patient money at an impatient rate.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 035 / 386

Floating-Rate Loans

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Credit

▼ Rising Interest Rates x2

When rates rise the borrowers pay more, which is the hedge and also the credit risk.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 077 / 386

Interest Rate Cap

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

Requires a Financials funding source.

Halve your loss from Rising Interest Rates clauses (round down).

Pay a little every quarter so a rate spike can only hurt so much.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 147 / 386

Interest Rate Cap

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

Requires a Financials funding source.

Halve your loss from Rising Interest Rates clauses (round down).

Pay a little every quarter so a rate spike can only hurt so much.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 147 / 386

Credit Default Swap

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

Requires a Financials funding source.

When Credit clauses cost you Surplus, regain up to 6 of it. Then discard this.

Insurance on someone else's loan, sold by someone who may not be around to pay.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 148 / 386

Committed Credit Line

TREATY



COST

◆ 2

Carrying Cost: 1 Surplus per Liquidity exposure you carry, including converted exposures. *Pay it at the start of your turn or discard this.*

Your Liquidity exposures don't count.

Any time: discard this to add 4 Leverage. At the start of your next turn, lose 2 Surplus.

The best time to ask for cash is before everyone else needs it.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 124 / 386

Branch Network Manager

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 4

Requires a Financials funding source.

You may add an additional Financials funding source each turn.

Opens a branch next to every coffee shop, and a coffee shop in every branch.

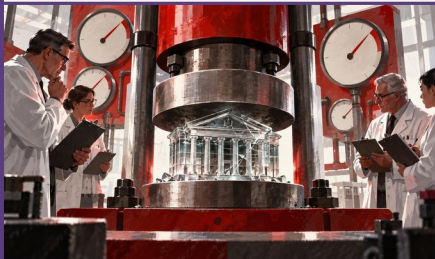
F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 226 / 386

Supervisory Stress Test

REGULATION



COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

▲ Credit ▲ Liquidity

Target opponent loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure, 3 per Liquidity exposure, and 1 per Dark card on their board. Then they can't add a funding source on their next turn.

The regulators ran their annual stress test, and this year you were the stress.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 311 / 386

Reserve Charge

CORPORATE



COST

◆ 7

HITS

Target opponent

Target opponent loses 2 Surplus per funding source they control.

A one-time charge, for the fourth year running.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 295 / 386

Treasurer

RISK & COMPLIANCE



HIRE

◆ 2

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity clauses.

Knows where every dollar is at 4 p.m., and where it has to be by 9 a.m.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 211 / 386

Credit Cards

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Credit ▼ Rising Interest Rates

The rate floats up with the market, the balance floats up with the holidays.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 078 / 386

Credit Cards

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Credit ▼ Rising Interest Rates

The rate floats up with the market, the balance floats up with the holidays.

F

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 078 / 386

INVESTMENT

Credit Cards

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 3

YIELD

● 2 each turn

SALE

2 any time

▲ Credit

▼ Rising Interest Rates

The rate floats up with the market, the balance floats up with the holidays.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 078 / 386

INVESTMENT

Mortgage Lending

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Credit

Thirty years of payments, secured by a house that is definitely worth what the appraisal says.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 079 / 386

INVESTMENT

Mortgage Lending

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Credit

Thirty years of payments, secured by a house that is definitely worth what the appraisal says.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 079 / 386

INVESTMENT

Mortgage Lending

INVESTMENT



COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

SALE

1 any time

▲ Credit

Thirty years of payments, secured by a house that is definitely worth what the appraisal says.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 079 / 386

SIGNATURE FUNDING SOURCE

Venture Deposits

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Short-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

A bank run makes you discard half your Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

Two hundred founders, one group chat, and a strong opinion about Thursday.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 038 / 386

SIGNATURE FUNDING SOURCE

Banking-as-a-Service

FINANCIALS



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 0 run start

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

The bank held the money, the app held the list, and the app went bankrupt.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 039 / 386

TALENT

Cross-Sell Champion

FRONT LINE



HIRE

◆ 2

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Requires a Financials funding source.

You may add an additional Financials funding source each turn.

Eight accounts per household, several of which the household was surprised to learn it had.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 230 / 386

OFFICE LOCATION

London

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 4 branch only

▲ Liquidity

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Specialty funding sources you control, rounded down.

The first Treaty or Cover you play on your turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

There is a market for that, and it meets at lunch.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 359 / 386

TOOL

Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Scenario Rehearsal

ACTION - YOUR TURN



COST

◆ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

On your turn, privately look at the next 2 shared pile cards. Return them in either order, then discard this. Developing and delayed Stress Tests still happen first.

The disasters are still coming. The order is negotiable.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 175 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET - AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

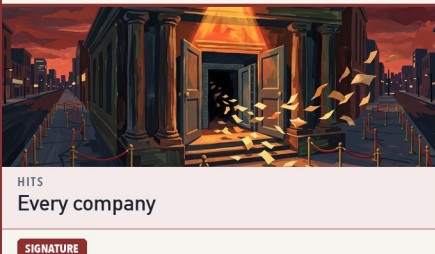
In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 312 / 386

Northern Rock Bank Run

LIQUIDITY - AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure. Then each company discards half its Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds, Private Credit Fund, or Feeder Fund it controls.

In September 2007, Northern Rock sought emergency support as wholesale funding dried up. Depositors queued outside its branches.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 275 / 386

Affordable Care Act

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 256 / 386

Subprime Meltdown

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit ▲ Property Value ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Credit exposure, 6 per Property Value exposure, and 3 per Volatility exposure.

In 2007 the adjustable-rate mortgages written with no income checks began to reset, and the loans bundled into AAA-rated bonds defaulted by the hundreds of thousands. The bonds' ratings were the last thing to go.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 310 / 386

World War III

GEOPOLITICAL



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Inflation ▲ Mortality ▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Property Value

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 6 per Mortality exposure, 6 per Long-Term Equity exposure, 6 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 6 per Property Value exposure, plus 6 more.

"I know not with what weapons World War III will be fought, but World War IV will be fought with sticks and stones." —Albert Einstein

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 278 / 386

Bird Flu Pandemic

MORTALITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

Talk about a viral tweet!

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 248 / 386

Quantitative Easing

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 2008



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Low Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Low Interest Rates exposure.

In November 2008, the Federal Reserve began buying hundreds of billions of dollars of bonds to push long-term interest rates down. It was very clear about its plans, which was the problem.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 257 / 386

Solvency II

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2016



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

On January 1, 2016, Solvency II took effect for insurers across the European Union, after more than a decade of consultation and several delays.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 294 / 386

1918 Influenza

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 1918



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Long-Term Equity exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Cat Bond - Mortality it controls.

The 1918 influenza pandemic swept the world in three waves and killed tens of millions of people, many of them young adults.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 247 / 386

Nationalized Healthcare Passes

REGULATION



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure. Then each company commits all its Health funding sources.

The best healthcare that money can't buy.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 264 / 386

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 293 / 386

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 386

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 291 / 386

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 346 / 386

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 263 / 386

Great Bond Massacre

RATES · AS-IF REPLAY, 1994



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Rising Interest Rates exposure and 3 per Volatility exposure.

On February 4, 1994, the Federal Reserve raised rates by surprise and kept raising them all year, and bond prices fell around the world. Orange County found out in December.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 309 / 386